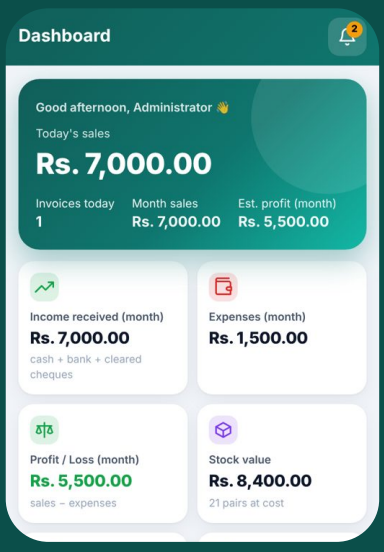
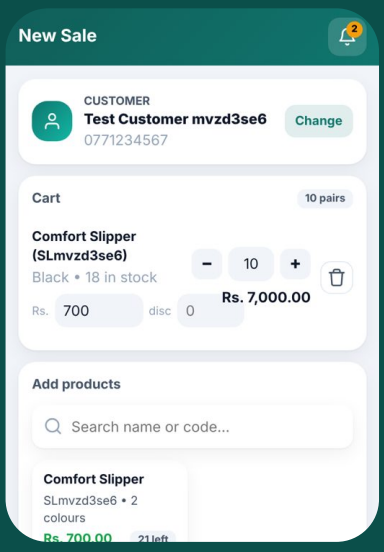
ARA GROUP

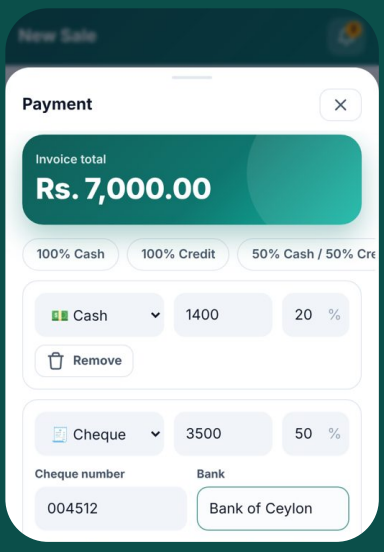
POS & Store Management System

User Manual

For owners, managers, cashiers, store keepers and accountants.
Covers every screen: sales, stock, payments, cheques, expenses, reports, users and settings.







Version 1.0 | Node.js + MySQL | Works on phone, tablet and computer

Contents

1	Getting Started	3
2	Dashboard	4
3	Products	5
4	Stock Control	6
5	Making a Sale (POS)	7
6	Payments: Cash, Cheque, Credit	8
7	Invoices	9
8	Adding Payments Later	10
9	Pending Payments & Reminders	11
10	Customers & Statements	12
11	Cheques	13
12	Suppliers	14
13	Expenses	15
14	Reports	16
15	Notifications	17
16	Users, Roles & Permissions	18
17	Settings: Company & WhatsApp	19
18	Settings: Email, Templates, Alerts, Backup	20
19	Daily Routine & Good Practice	21
20	Questions & Answers	22
21	Quick Reference	23

1. Getting Started

ARA POS is a web system. You open it in a browser on any phone, tablet or computer - nothing to install. On a phone it looks and feels like a mobile app.

Signing in

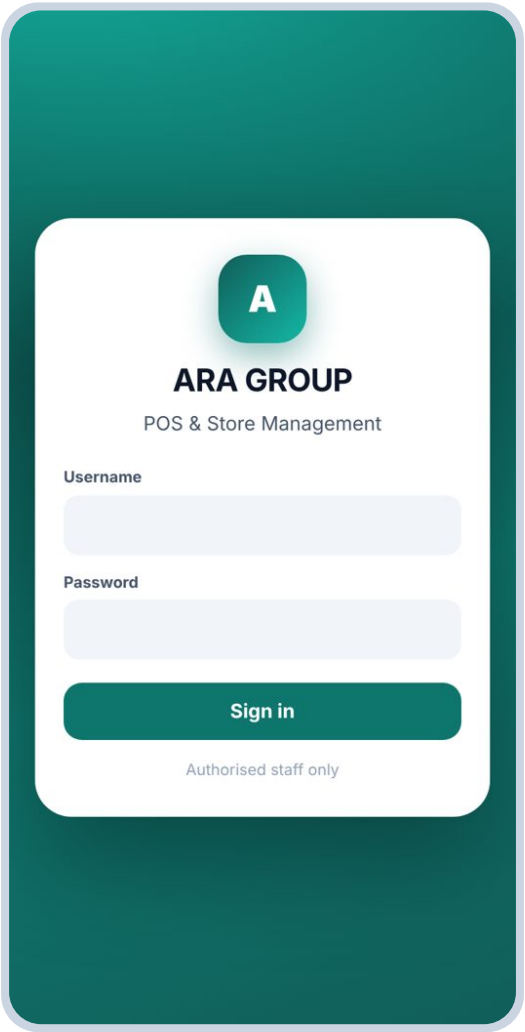
1. Open the address given by your administrator (for example https://pos.yourdomain.com).
2. Type your username and password, then tap Sign in.
3. The first administrator login is admin / admin123. Change it immediately: More > Password.

Install it like an app (recommended)

- Android (Chrome): menu with three dots > Add to Home screen / Install app.
- iPhone (Safari): Share button > Add to Home Screen.
- Computer (Chrome / Edge): install icon at the right of the address bar.

Finding your way around

- Bottom bar: Home, Invoices, the orange + button (New Sale), Stock and More.
- More: all other sections - Customers, Pending Payments, Products, Suppliers, Cheques, Expenses, Reports, Notifications, Users, Settings and Activity Log.
- On a computer the same menu appears as a sidebar on the left.
- The bell at the top shows new alerts. The back arrow returns to the previous screen.
- You only see the menus your role allows. If something is missing, ask the administrator to change your role.



Sign-in screen

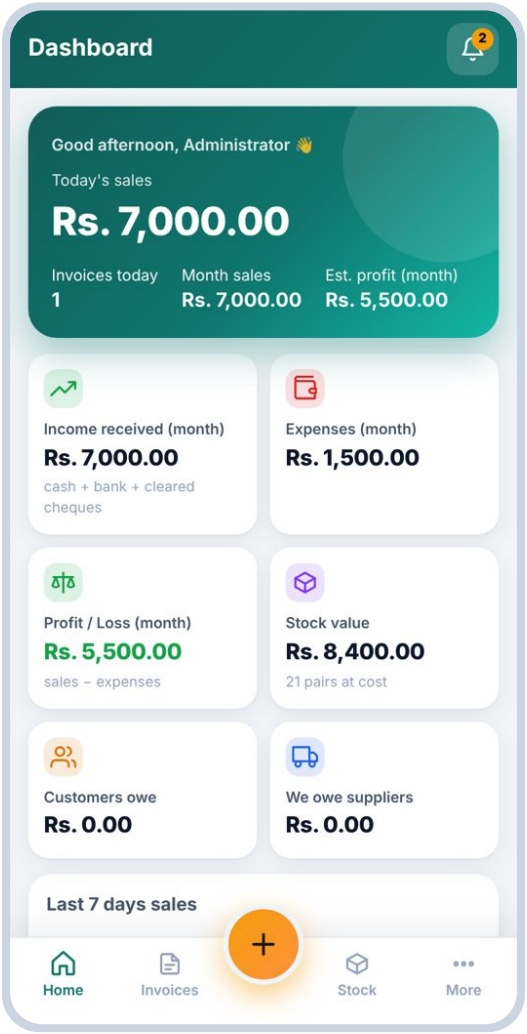
2. Dashboard

The Home screen answers "how is the business doing right now?" at a glance.

What you see

- Today's sales, number of invoices today and this month's sales in the green card.
- Income received this month: cash + bank + cleared cheques only.
- Expenses this month and Profit / Loss (sales minus expenses).
- Stock value (quantity x cost price) and total pairs in the store.
- Customers owe: total outstanding balances. We owe suppliers: supplier balances.
- Last 7 days sales chart.
- Customer cheques to deposit and supplier cheques to pay in the next 7 days (red = overdue).
- Low stock products that need re-ordering.

> Tap any "All" / "View" button to jump to the full list. Tap a recent invoice to open it.



Dashboard on a phone

3. Products

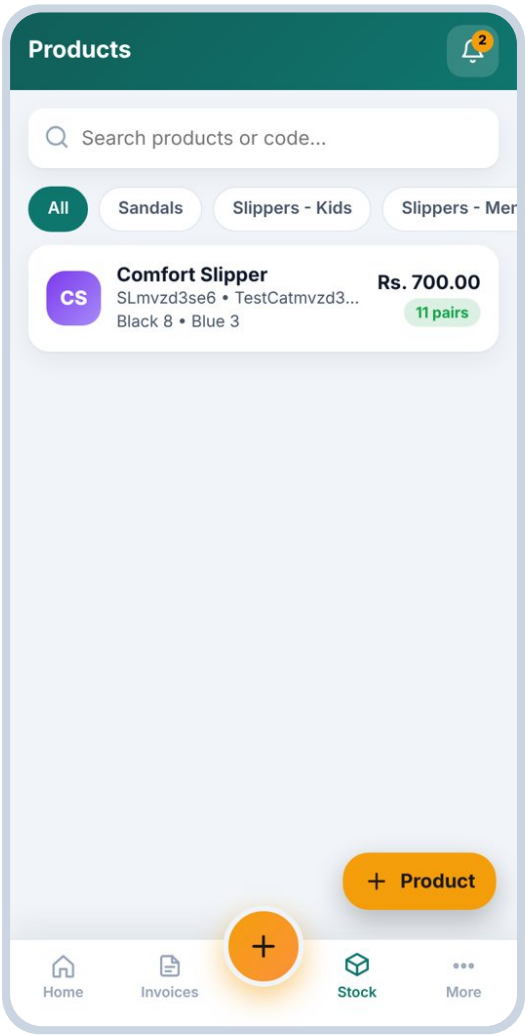
Products are finished slippers. Each product can have several colours, and stock is tracked per colour.

Add a product

1. Open Stock (or More > Products) and tap the orange + Product button.
2. Enter the Product name and Product code (the code must be unique).
3. Choose Category, Brand and Supplier. If it is not in the list choose "+ Add new..." at the bottom of the list, type the name and it is selected automatically.
4. Enter Cost price, Wholesale price and Selling price.
5. Under Colours, type each colour and its Opening quantity (the pairs you already have). Tap Add colour for more.
6. Set the Low-stock alert number, then tap Create product.

Edit or delete

- Tap a product in the list to see details, then Edit or the bin icon.
- In Edit you can rename colours, add new colours and change prices. Existing stock is changed only through Stock actions so there is always a record.
- A product that has been sold cannot be erased - it is made inactive instead and disappears from the POS.



Product list

4. Stock Control

Stock goes up when you receive goods and down when you sell. Every change is recorded with date, user and reason.

Receive goods into the store

1. Stock > Receive goods.
2. Choose the supplier, the received date and the delivery note number.
3. Select product and colour, enter the quantity (and unit cost if different). Tap Add another item for more lines.
4. Tick "Update product cost price" if the new cost should replace the old one.
5. Tap Add to stock. A receipt number (GRN-...) is created and the supplier balance increases.

Returns, damages and adjustments

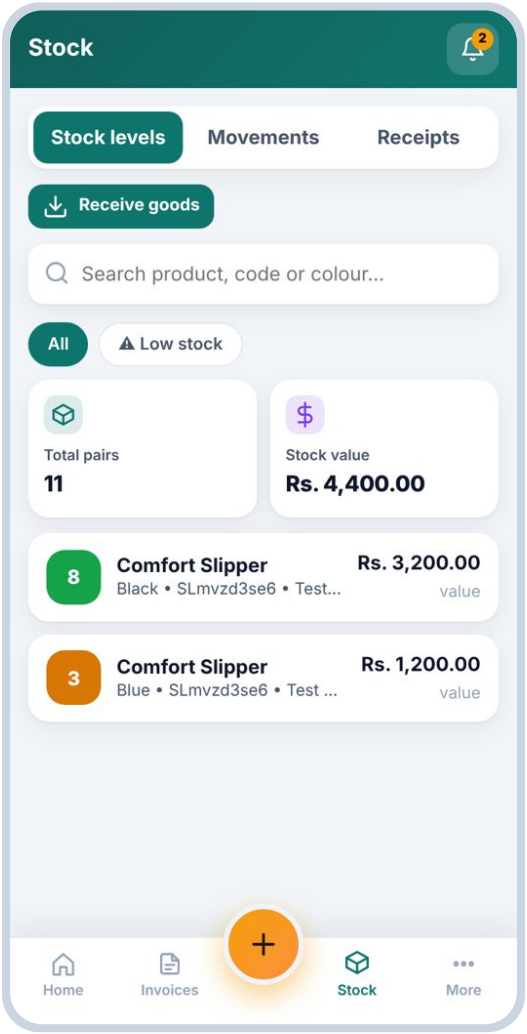
- Customer return - adds stock back.
- Return to supplier - removes stock.
- Damaged - removes stock (write-off).
- Adjust - plus or minus after a stock count; a reason is required.

Tap any row in Stock levels and choose:

History

- Movements tab: every change, who made it and the balance after it. Filter by type.
- Receipts tab: all goods received.

> Low-stock rows are orange and out-of-stock rows are red. Use the Low stock filter to build your re-order list.



Stock levels

5. Making a Sale (POS)

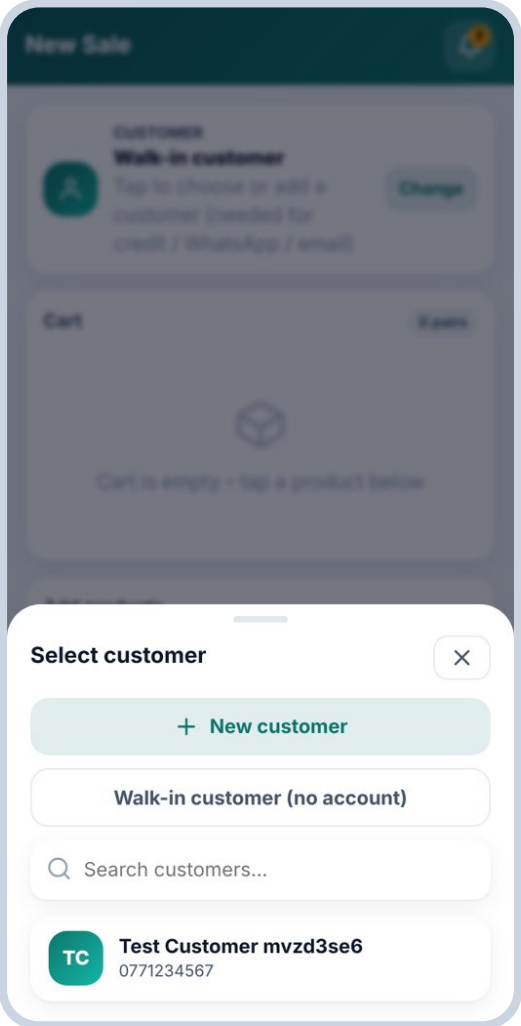
The orange + button opens the point of sale. It is designed for one-hand use on a phone.

Create an invoice

1. Tap the Customer card. Choose an existing customer, tap New customer, or choose Walk-in customer. A customer is needed for credit sales, WhatsApp and email.
2. Search or scroll the products and tap one. If it has several colours, choose the colour.
3. In the cart change the quantity with + / -, or edit the price and a line discount.
4. Tap Discount for an invoice-level discount.
5. Tap Pay & Save to take payment (next page).

> Wholesale customers automatically get wholesale prices. You can still change any price in the cart.

> The system will not sell more than you have in stock (unless the administrator allowed negative stock).



Choose customer

6. Payments: Cash, Cheque, Credit

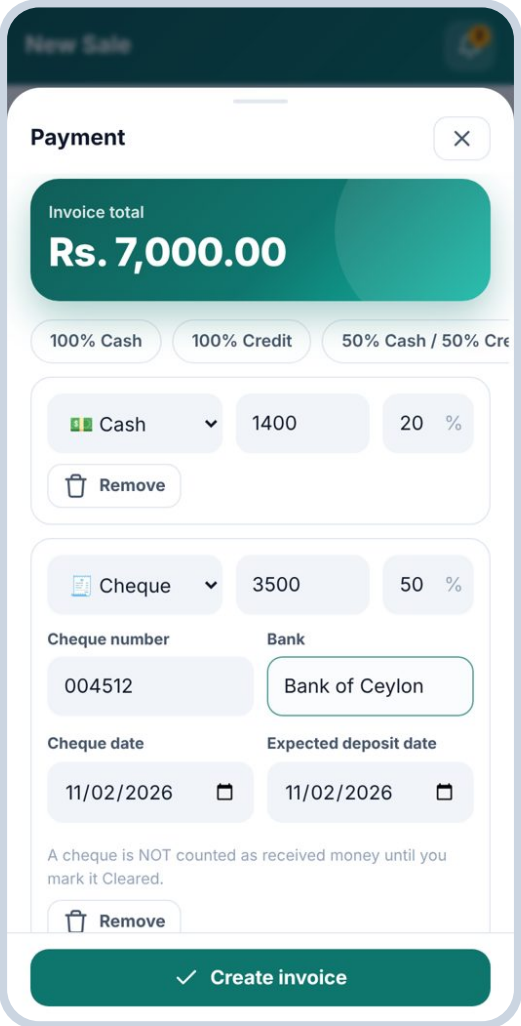
One invoice can be paid in several ways at once. Whatever is not paid is automatically kept as Pending for that customer.

Split an invoice

1. After Pay & Save, the payment screen shows the invoice total.
2. Use a quick button - 100% Cash, 100% Credit, 50/50, or 20% cash / 50% cheque / 30% pending - or build your own.
3. Each row has a method (Cash, Bank transfer, Cheque), an amount and a percentage. Change either; the other updates.
4. Tap Add payment method for more rows. The orange Pending box shows what is left.
5. For a cheque enter the cheque number, bank, cheque date and expected deposit date.
6. If money is still pending, set the payment due date.
7. Tick WhatsApp / Email to send the invoice, then tap Create invoice.

> Example: Rs. 100,000 invoice = 20% cash (20,000) + 50% cheque (50,000) + 30% pending (30,000).

> A cheque is NOT treated as received money until you mark it Cleared in the Cheques section.



Split payment

7. Invoices

Everything about a sale is on its invoice page. Invoice numbers are automatic: ARA-2026-00001, 00002 ...

After creating an invoice

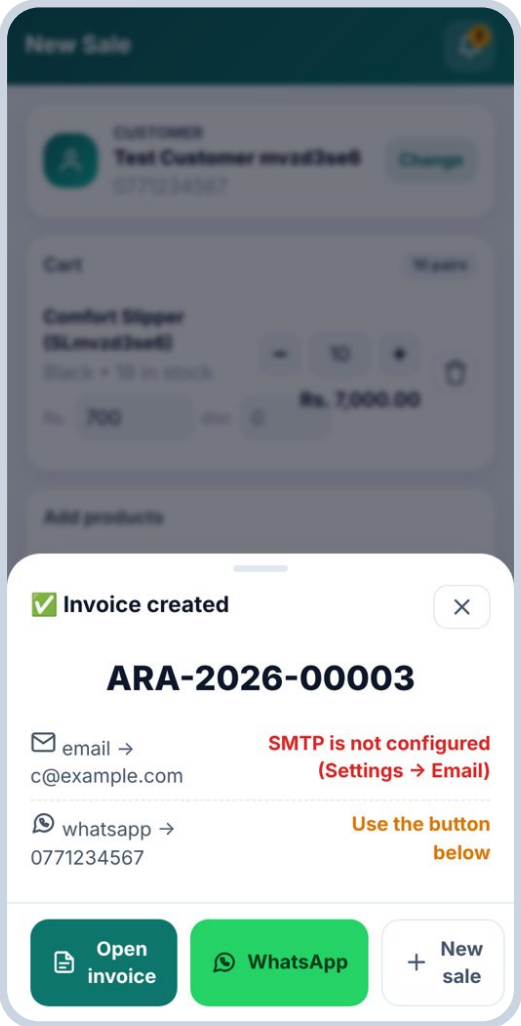
- A confirmation shows the invoice number and the result of the email / WhatsApp sending.
- Open invoice, WhatsApp (opens WhatsApp with the message ready) and New sale buttons are offered.

Invoice page

- Customer, dates, items, totals, paid amount, cheque amount not yet cleared and balance due.
- Status: Unpaid, Partially Paid, Pending, Cheque Pending or Paid.
- Payments list with edit and delete buttons. Add payment records a later payment (any date, any method).
- PDF, WhatsApp, Email, Edit and Delete buttons.
- Delivery log: every WhatsApp / email that was sent and whether it worked.

Edit or delete

Edit changes customer, items, prices, discount and dates; stock is corrected automatically. Delete returns the stock and removes the invoice and its payments. Both are written to the Activity Log with your name.



Invoice created

8. Adding Payments Later

Customers often take goods first and pay later, in parts. Record every payment against the invoice.

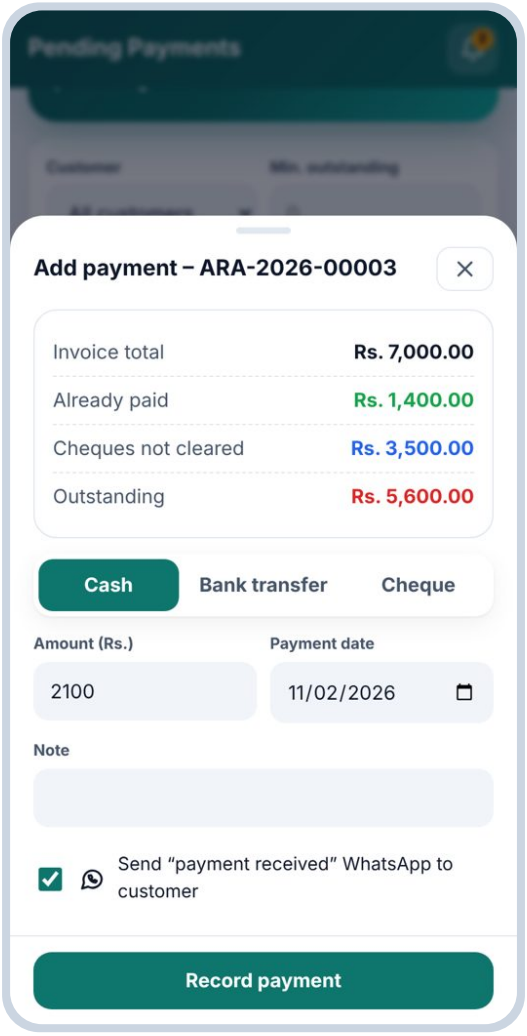
Record a payment

1. Open the invoice and tap Add payment (or use the button on the Pending Payments page).
2. Choose Cash, Bank transfer or Cheque. The amount is pre-filled with the outstanding balance - change it for a part payment.
3. Pick the payment date. For a cheque fill in the cheque details.
4. Tick the WhatsApp box to tell the customer "payment received".
5. Tap Record payment. The invoice status and the customer balance update immediately.

Automatic statuses

- Unpaid - nothing paid, no credit arrangement.
- Pending - sold on credit, balance outstanding.
- Partially Paid - some cleared money received.
- Cheque Pending - cheque taken but not cleared.
- Paid - the full amount is settled with cleared money.

> You cannot record more than the remaining balance. To correct a mistake, edit or delete the payment on the invoice page.



Add payment

9. Pending Payments & Reminders

More > Pending Payments lists every invoice that still has a balance.

What it shows

- Customer, invoice number and date, invoice amount, amount paid, outstanding balance, due date and a progress bar.
- Payment history for each invoice (tap to expand).

Filters

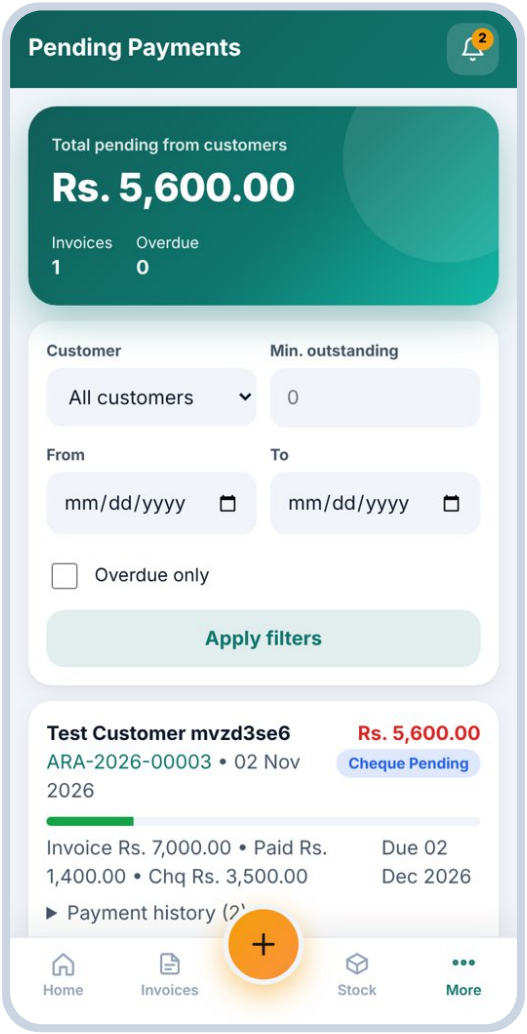
Customer, from / to date, minimum outstanding amount, and Overdue only.

Actions

- Add payment - record money received.
- Remind - sends the overdue-reminder template on WhatsApp. If the gateway is off, WhatsApp opens with the message ready to send.

Automatic reminders

The system checks every 30 minutes. Overdue invoices create a notification (bell icon). In Settings > Alerts you can also forward alerts to your own WhatsApp / email, or let the system WhatsApp customers when an invoice becomes overdue.



Pending payments

10. Customers & Statements

Every customer has a separate history. Search by name, phone or email; the Owing money filter shows only customers with balances.

Customer page

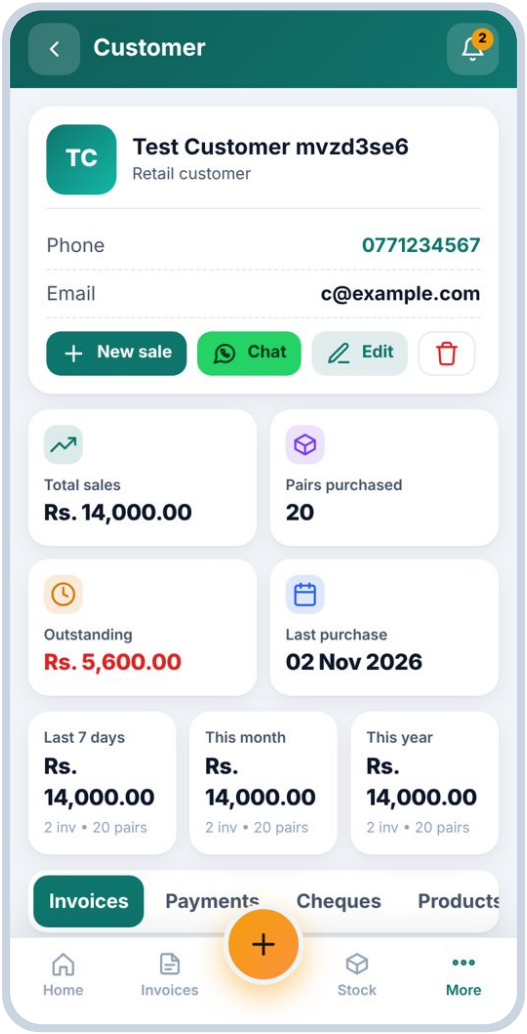
- Total sales, pairs purchased, outstanding balance and last purchase date.
- Sales for the last 7 days, this month and this year.
- Tabs: Invoices, Payments, Cheques, Products bought and Statement.
- Buttons: New sale for this customer, WhatsApp chat, Edit, Delete (a customer with invoices is deactivated instead).

Customer statement

1. Open the customer, tap the Statement tab.
2. Choose the From and To dates and tap Show: opening balance, every invoice, payment and cheque, and the closing balance.
3. Tap PDF to download, or WhatsApp / Email to send it to the customer.

Add a customer

Customers > + Customer. Enter name, type (Retail or Wholesale), phone, WhatsApp number, email, address and credit limit. The email and WhatsApp number are used for automatic invoice delivery.



Customer page

11. Cheques

More > Cheques tracks cheques you receive from customers and cheques you give to suppliers.

Customer cheques

- Received - in your hand.
- Deposited - taken to the bank.
- Cleared - money is in your account. Only now is the invoice counted as paid.
- Bounced - returned unpaid. The invoice balance returns and you get an alert. Tick the box to notify the customer on WhatsApp.

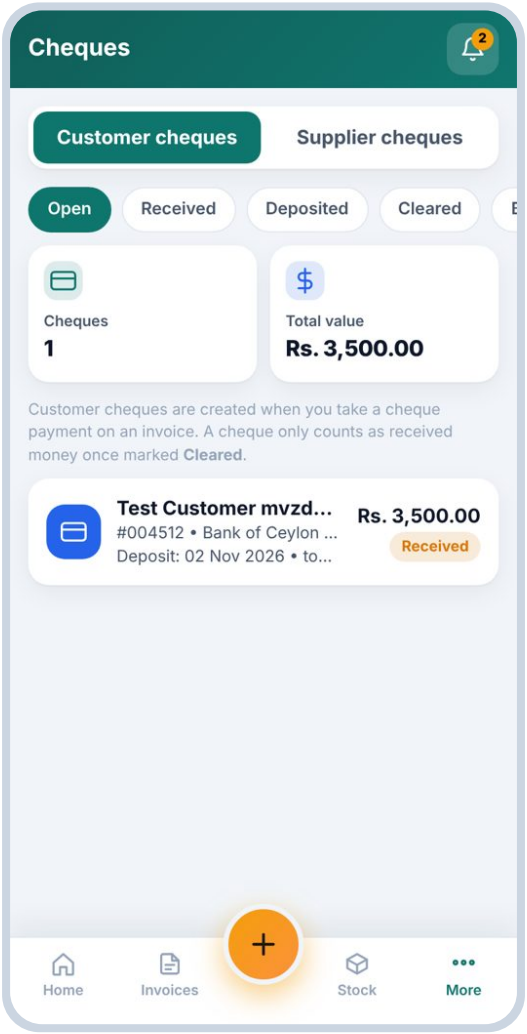
Created automatically when you take a cheque payment. Tap a cheque to update its status:

Supplier cheques

1. Cheques > Supplier cheques > Issue supplier cheque (or from the supplier page).
2. Choose the supplier, cheque number, bank, amount, cheque date and the date it will be presented to the bank.
3. Update the status as it moves: Issued, Presented, Cleared or Returned. Cleared reduces the supplier balance.

Reminders

You are alerted a few days before every deposit or presentation date (set in Settings > Alerts), on the day, and when a date has been missed.



Customer cheques

12. Suppliers

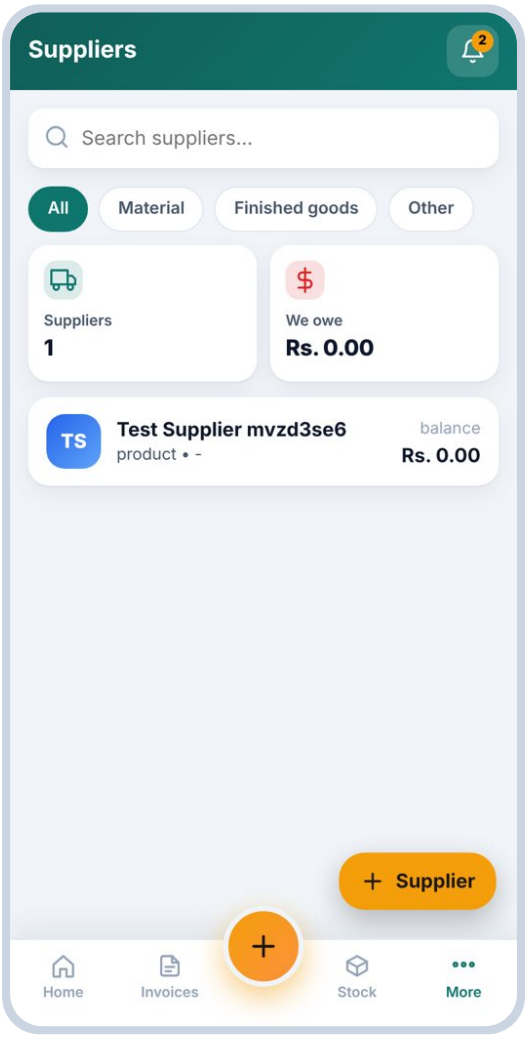
Keep material suppliers, finished-goods suppliers and other suppliers separately.

Supplier page

- Balance owed = opening balance + goods received - payments - cleared cheques.
- Tabs: Payments, Cheques, Goods received, Expenses.
- Payment records cash or bank payments. Issue cheque creates a supplier cheque.

Add a supplier

Suppliers > + Supplier. Enter name, type, contact, phone, email, address and the opening balance you already owe. You can also add a supplier quickly from the product form or the Receive goods form.



Suppliers

13. Expenses

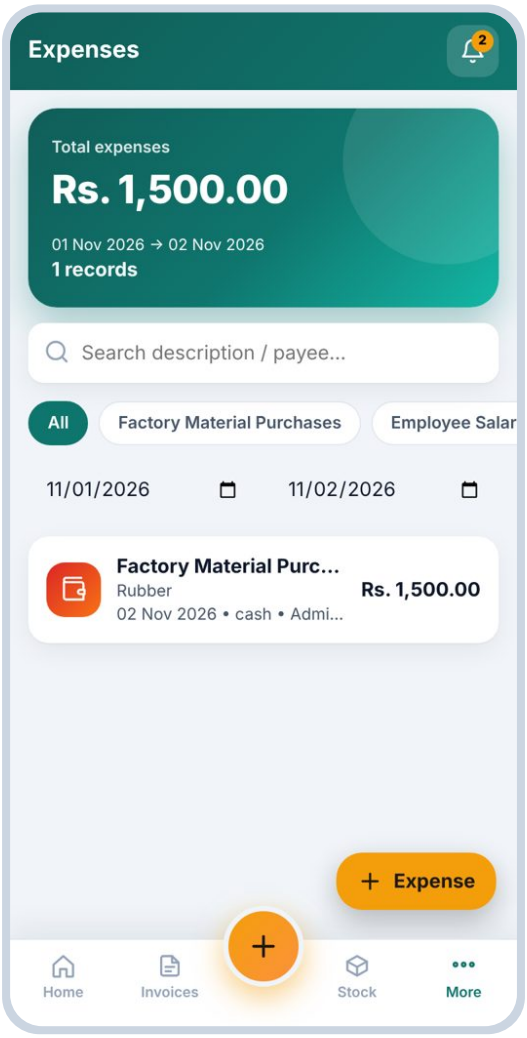
Record every business and factory expense. Raw materials are recorded here as expenses (they are not tracked as stock).

Add an expense

1. Expenses > + Expense.
2. Enter the date and amount, and choose a category: Factory material purchases, Salaries and wages, Factory expenses, Electricity and water, Transport and delivery, Repairs and maintenance, Rent, or Other. You can add your own category from the list.
3. Add a description, payment method, supplier (optional) and who was paid.
4. Take a photo of the receipt or choose a PDF (up to 8 MB).
5. Tap Save.

Review

- Filter by category and date range; the total shows at the top.
- Tap an expense to view the receipt, who added it and who last edited it. Edit or delete from there.



Expense list

14. Reports

More > Reports gives income, expense and profit / loss for any day, week, month, year or custom range.

Using reports

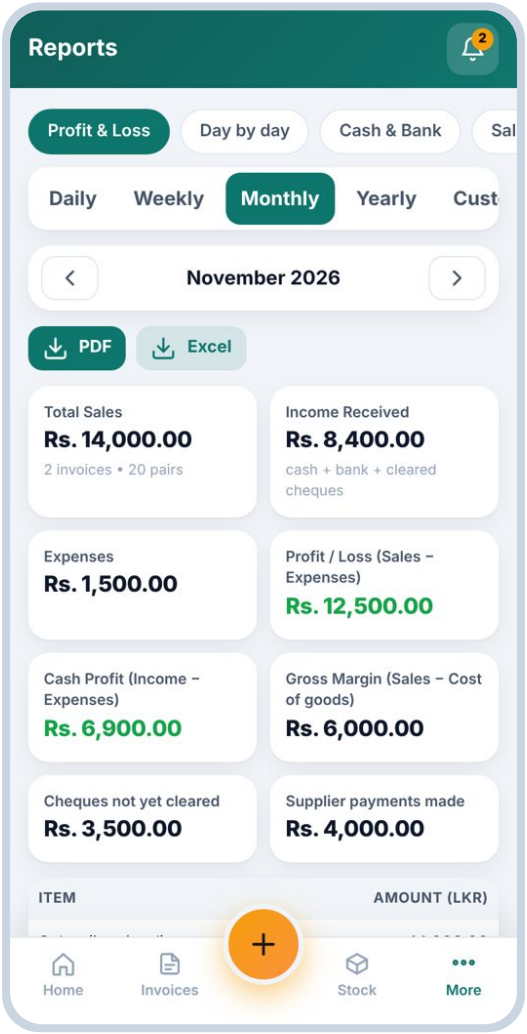
1. Choose a report from the chips at the top.
2. Choose Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly or Custom. Use the arrows to move to the previous or next period.
3. Tap PDF or Excel to download.

Available reports

- Profit & Loss - sales, income by method, expenses by category, profit and loss.
- Day by day - each day's sales, income, expenses and profit.
- Cash & Bank - money in and money out.
- Sales, Products (sales performance), Customers (outstanding), Suppliers (balances).
- Expenses, Cheques register, and current Stock with value.

How profit is calculated

- Profit / Loss = Sales - Expenses for the period.
- Cash Profit = Income actually received (cash, bank, cleared cheques) - Expenses.
- Gross Margin = Sales - cost price of the goods sold.



Profit & Loss report

15. Notifications

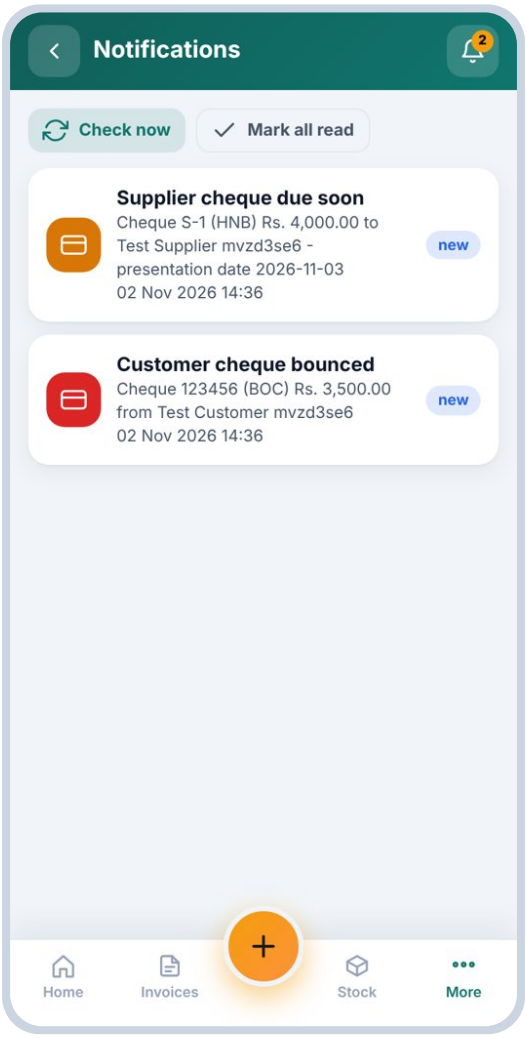
The bell icon shows how many new alerts you have.

You are alerted about

- Customer cheques due for deposit, deposit overdue, deposited but not cleared, and bounced.
- Supplier cheques due soon, due today and overdue.
- Customer invoices that are overdue.
- Products that are low or out of stock.

Using them

- Tap a notification to mark it read and jump to the related screen.
- Check now scans immediately; Mark all read clears the badge.
- Optional: forward alerts to WhatsApp / email (Settings > Alerts).



Notifications

16. Users, Roles & Permissions

Every employee has their own login so you know who created or changed each record. Only people with the right permission see these screens.

Create a user

1. More > Users > + User.
2. Enter name, username, password (6+ characters), email, phone and choose a Role.
3. Tap Save. The employee can sign in straight away.

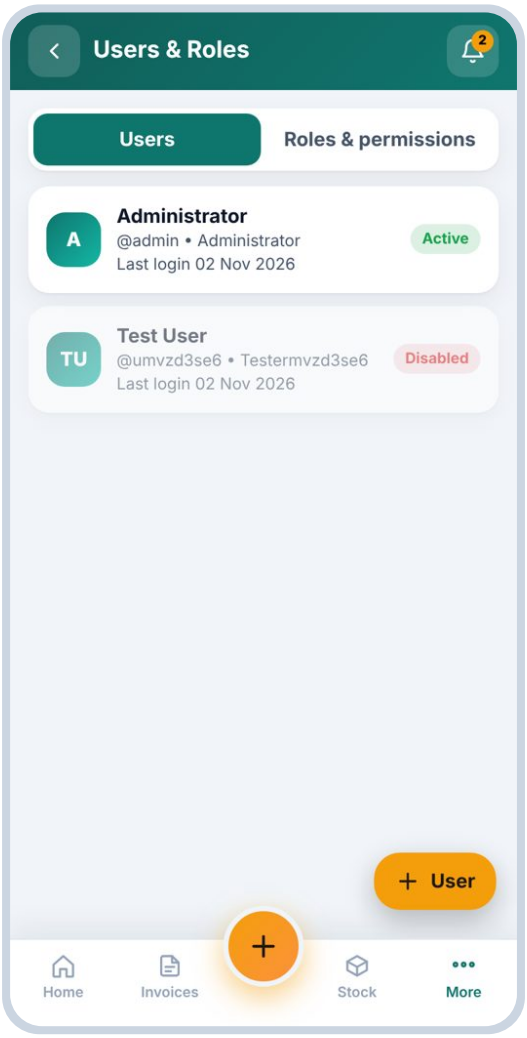
Deactivate or delete

Open the user and untick "Account active" to block login but keep history. Delete works only for users with no activity.

Roles

1. Users > Roles tab > + Role (or open an existing one).
2. Name the role and tick exactly what it may do: view / create / edit / delete invoices, record payments, send invoices, manage customers, products, stock, suppliers, cheques, expenses, reports, users, settings, backups and the activity log.
3. Use "toggle all" to tick a whole group. Save.

> Ready-made roles: Administrator (everything), Manager, Cashier, Store Keeper, Accountant. Change them or make your own.



Users

17. Settings: Company & WhatsApp

More > Settings (administrators). Tap Save settings on each tab after changing it.

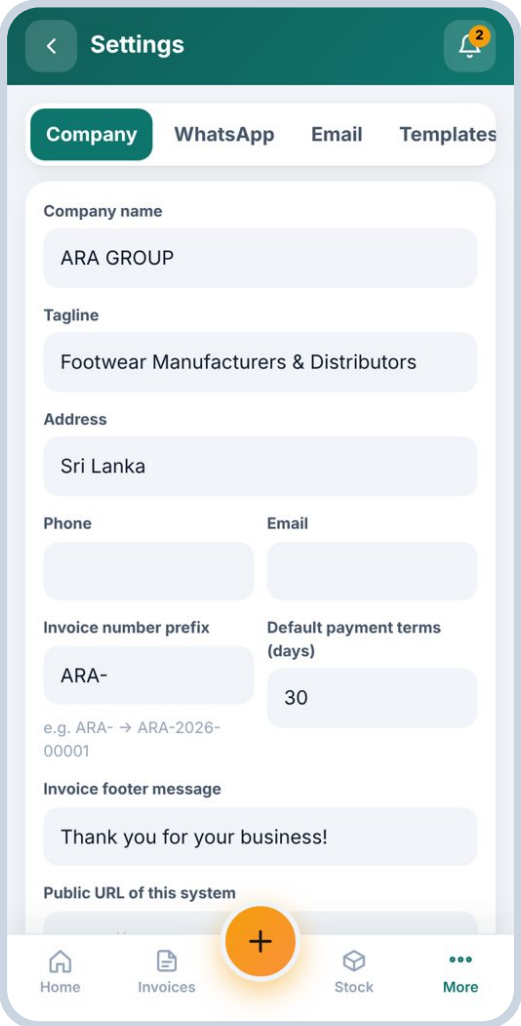
Company

- Name, tagline, address, phone, email: these appear on every PDF invoice.
- Invoice prefix (ARA- gives ARA-2026-00001), payment terms in days and the invoice footer message.
- Public URL: your website address, used in WhatsApp / email invoice links.
- Default country code 94: a number typed as 0771234567 is sent as 94771234567.
- Allow negative stock: lets cashiers sell when the system shows 0.

WhatsApp gateway (ecodes.online)

1. Settings > WhatsApp. Tick Enable WhatsApp gateway.
2. Enter the API URL, send path, HTTP method, API key and sender / device ID from your ecodes.online account.
3. Edit the request body template so it matches the ecodes.online documentation. Placeholders: {{api_key}} {{sender}} {{to}} {{message}} {{media_url}} {{filename}}.
4. Type your own number and tap Send test.
5. Tick "Send invoice automatically on WhatsApp" if you want every invoice sent.

> If the gateway is off or fails, every WhatsApp button opens WhatsApp itself with the message ready, so you can always send manually.



Company settings

18. Settings: Email, Templates, Alerts, Backup

Email (SMTP)

Enter host, port, username, password and the From address. Gmail: host smtp.gmail.com, port 587, and use an App Password. Tap Send test. Invoices are then emailed with the PDF attached.

Templates

Edit the wording of every message: invoice, payment received, overdue reminder, statement, bounced cheque and admin alerts. Tap a placeholder chip (such as {{customer}} or {{balance}}) to insert it. Use *text* for bold on WhatsApp. You can add custom templates and choose them when sending an invoice.

Alerts

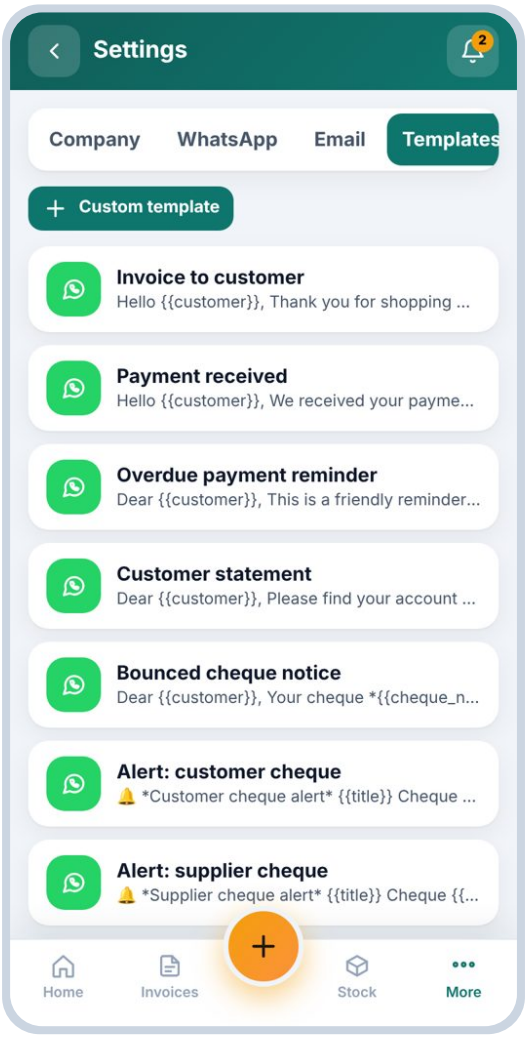
- Days before a cheque date to remind you.
- Forward alerts to your WhatsApp number and / or email.
- Automatically WhatsApp customers when an invoice becomes overdue.

Backup

- A backup of the whole database is made automatically every night at 2:00 AM.
- Tap Create backup now at any time, and tap a backup file to download it. Keep a copy off-site regularly.

Sent log

Shows every WhatsApp and email sent by the system with its status (Sent, Failed, or Manual link).



Message templates

19. Daily Routine & Good Practice

Opening

- Check the Dashboard and Notifications: cheques to deposit, overdue customers, low stock.
- Receive any deliveries into Stock before selling.

During the day

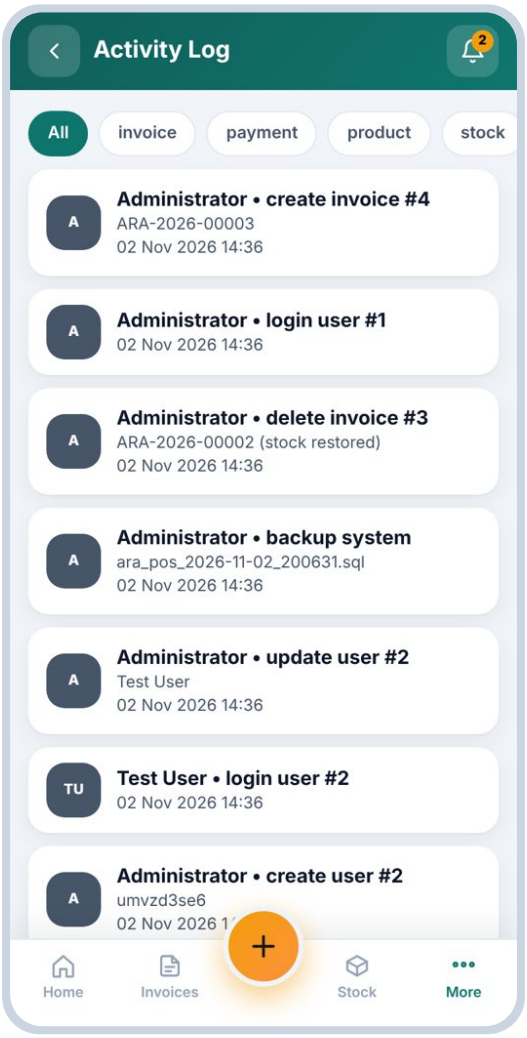
- Every sale through New Sale - never sell without an invoice.
- Record each customer payment on its invoice at the time it is received.
- Record expenses when they are paid and keep the receipt photo.

Closing

- Deposit cheques and update their status (Deposited, then Cleared when confirmed by the bank).
- Open Reports > Day by day to see the day's sales, income and expenses.
- Do stock counts regularly: use Adjust with a reason for any difference.

Security

- One login per person. Never share passwords; change the default admin password.
- Give each person only the permissions they need.
- Review the Activity Log (More > Activity Log) to see who did what.
- Deactivate accounts of people who leave.



Activity log

20. Questions & Answers

Frequently asked

- I made a mistake on an invoice. Open it and tap Edit (needs the edit permission). Stock and totals are fixed automatically.
- The customer paid by cheque - is it counted as paid? Not until you mark the cheque Cleared.
- A cheque bounced. Mark it Bounced on the Cheques screen; the balance returns to the invoice.
- WhatsApp did not send. Check Settings > WhatsApp and the Sent log. Use the WhatsApp button to open and send manually.
- Email says SMTP is not configured. Fill in Settings > Email.
- I cannot see a menu. Your role does not include it - ask the administrator.
- I forgot my password. An administrator can set a new one in Users.
- Can I use it on my phone and the shop computer at the same time? Yes. All devices share one database.
- How do I restore a backup? Ask your hosting / IT person to import the downloaded .sql file into the MySQL database.

21. Quick Reference

Roles at a glance

- Administrator: everything.
- Manager: all business screens, but not users, roles, settings or backups.
- Cashier: POS, payments, customers, invoice sending.
- Store Keeper: products, stock, goods received.
- Accountant: payments, cheques, suppliers, expenses, reports.

Payment status	Meaning
Unpaid	No payment received
Pending	Sold on credit - balance outstanding
Partially Paid	Part of the amount is received (cleared)
Cheque Pending	A cheque is held but not yet cleared
Paid	Fully settled with cleared money
Cheque: Received	In your hand
Cheque: Deposited	Taken to the bank
Cheque: Cleared	Money confirmed in the account
Cheque: Bounced	Returned unpaid - balance restored
Supplier cheque: Issued / Presented / Cleared / Returned	Given to supplier / sent to bank / paid / returned